

Name: _____

Date: _____

The Edge of the Pool

Year 3 reading comprehension · Story · 11 marks · About 15 minutes

Sam stood at the edge of the swimming pool, gripping his towel. The water was bright blue and very, very deep. Around him, the other children splashed and shouted, but Sam did not move.

“Come on, Sam,” called Miss Patel, the swimming teacher. “You can start in the shallow end.”

Sam’s knees felt wobbly. His tummy was full of fluttering butterflies. He looked down at his toes, which were curled tightly over the edge of the pool.

Then he noticed Jamal, a boy from his class, giving him a thumbs up from the water. “It’s not cold once you’re in!” Jamal grinned.

Sam took one slow, deep breath. He sat down on the edge and slid carefully into the water. It was cooler than he expected, but it wasn’t scary at all. His feet touched the bottom, and his shoulders came down from around his ears.

By the end of the lesson, Sam was floating on his back with a huge smile on his face. “Same time next week?” asked Miss Patel. “Yes, please!” said Sam.

1. What was the name of the swimming teacher? (1 mark)

2. Who gave Sam a thumbs up? (1 mark)

3. Find and copy one word that describes how Sam’s knees felt. (1 mark)

4. How did Sam feel at the start of the story? Use a detail from the story to explain how you know. (2 marks)

5. The story says Sam's tummy was full of "fluttering butterflies". Did Sam really have butterflies in his tummy? Explain what the writer means. (2 marks)

6. What helped Sam to get into the water? (1 mark)

7. How do you know Sam enjoyed the lesson? Give one piece of evidence. (1 mark)

8. Number these events 1 to 4 in the order they happen. (2 marks)

- ☐ Sam floats on his back.
- ☐ Sam stands at the edge of the pool.
- ☐ Sam slides into the water.
- ☐ Jamal gives Sam a thumbs up.

Writing task: Write about a time you felt nervous and then felt proud. Say how your body felt.
